



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

INDUSTRIAL AUTOMATION & ENGINEERING SERVICES · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering past-due project invoices, retainage and change-order balances — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Pigler Automation** · August 2026

A recovery partner for the invoices that stall after the system is running

To the Pigler Automation team — thank you for reaching out. In control-systems integration the engineering hours are spent long before the money arrives. Design, build, FAT, commissioning: the cost is on your books the moment the work is done, and a plant owner or EPC that stops answering after the system is live is holding your margin, not theirs.

A past-due project invoice isn't an account-management problem — it's a working-capital problem. Every aged milestone, held retainage and disputed change order ties up cash you already converted into engineering labor, and quietly drifts toward write-off while your team stays busy on live projects.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working commercial B2B balances on **pure contingency since 2004**, with recovery reach across all 50 states. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes your AR aging export straight out of your accounting system, and we work them. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A track record built on high-volume B2B trade receivables and a documented, compliant process — the collections depth a 20-year engineering firm can plug in without pulling a project manager off billable work.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

The questions an integrator actually asks — answered directly

You reached out about a single unpaid B2B invoice. Here is exactly how third-party recovery works for project-based engineering AR, in the order it matters.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum, no per-account fee. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. Commercial rates scale with the age, balance and volume of what you place; a single invoice and a full aging file are quoted differently, and we tell you which makes sense for you.
2. Disputes over scope or performance	A scope or performance dispute pauses recovery — it doesn't end it. We validate the balance against the paper trail: the signed proposal or PO, the change-order authorizations, FAT and commissioning sign-offs, and the correspondence record. In integration work, a signed acceptance document is usually decisive. Dispute investigation typically adds 30–60 days.
3. Owners and EPCs that go silent	The core of what we do. Persistent multi-channel outreach, commercial skip tracing to locate the operating entity, successors and principals behind a business that has gone quiet, and legal-escalation review for accounts that still will not engage. A third-party demand on agency letterhead alone resolves a meaningful share of silent accounts.
4. Held retainage and stalled milestones	Large plant owners and EPCs rarely refuse to pay — they stall inside procurement. We work AP directly: matching invoice to PO and receipt, chasing the approval that stalled, and escalating to the buyer of record with documented, compliant outreach rather than another project-manager voicemail.
5. Onboarding & placement	Fast and low-lift. Place a single invoice, or bulk-upload an AR aging export through the portal — we map your columns, so no one re-keys anything. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement, and your engineers stay on billable work.

Aging-report-ready intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your AR exports and give your team live, self-service access throughout recovery.

AGING-REPORT-READY PLACEMENT

Place one invoice or upload a full AR aging export from your accounting system — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send proposals, POs, change orders, acceptance sign-offs and statements safely inside the portal — the documentation that settles a scope dispute fast.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a live view of your past-due book, not a monthly PDF.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a customer makes directly to Pigler Automation, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► [Portal Video Tour](#)

SWRS Commercial Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's commercial book, anonymized by sector and sized to the balances an engineering firm actually places. The spread is real and shown honestly — recovery tracks the age and documentation of what gets placed, not the pitch.

**CONTROLS &
INSTRUMENTATION FIRM**

**Sensing & measurement
systems**

\$9.4K recovered

of ~\$9.4K placed

100% recovered

ENGINEERING CONSULTANCY

Structural & civil design

\$3.9K recovered

of ~\$4.4K placed

89% recovered

ELECTRICAL CONTRACTOR

**Commercial & industrial
electrical**

\$19.2K recovered

of ~\$21.7K placed

89% recovered

**TECHNOLOGY & SYSTEMS
PROVIDER**

Integrated systems

\$96K recovered

of ~\$130K placed

74% recovered

**INDUSTRIAL EQUIPMENT
SUPPLIER**

Process equipment

\$10K recovered

of ~\$30.2K placed

33% recovered

ENGINEERING SERVICES FIRM

**Design & project
engineering**

\$9.6K recovered

of ~\$28K placed

34% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGE CURVE**Why a fresh project invoice recovers best**

A commercial balance is most collectible while it is fresh; every month it ages, contact data goes stale, the engineer or PM who authorized the work moves on, and leverage erodes. The highest-leverage change most engineering firms make is not chasing harder — it is placing sooner.

FRESH VS. AGED

Accounts under roughly 90 days past due often resolve in 30–60 days; balances that sit a year collect a fraction of that — which is what the 33–34% cards above look like.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed “place at 90 days” policy recovers materially more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there is no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

We speak DSO — and we reduce it

Every past-due project invoice is a DSO problem before it is a collections problem. The Hackett Group puts median DSO at 43.5 days, while the top quartile collects in 25.1 — those firms touch their cash more than 18 days sooner. When we recover an aged balance it comes off your receivables the day it clears, which moves the metric directly. [Read our breakdown of DSO vs. Average Collection Period — formulas, benchmarks and how to bring the number down →](#)



The 60-day escalation rule

Internal follow-up handles 15–30 days past due and management takes 30–60. Past 60, a documented third-party escalation recovers materially more than another PM voicemail — and on contingency it costs nothing to place.



Owners, EPCs & general contractors

Commercial skip tracing on the business and its principals, plus persistent multi-channel demand for customers who accepted the system and then went quiet.



Disputed scope & change orders

Documentation-driven validation — signed proposal, authorized change orders, FAT and commissioning sign-off — that separates a genuine performance claim from a stall tactic holding your DSO up.



Every commercial balance type

Milestone and progress billings, held retainage, change-order balances, support and service agreements, staff-augmentation hours — one partner, one portal, one number to watch.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement — and two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

Southwest Recovery Services is dedicated, as a family-run business, to making sure your needs and your collection expectations are not only met but exceeded — and we understand that we have to earn your trust as well as your business. I've dedicated my entire career to making that a reality for every single client, big or small.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Pigler Automation

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The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn your aging receivables back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk the invoice you reached out about, look at whatever else is aging behind it, and put a contingency rate against it.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for Pigler Automation. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.